

# The Boston Globe

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## The last time a college had its tax-exempt status pulled

Bob Jones University lost its standing over a ban on interracial dating

By Jim Puzzanghera  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — If Harvard loses its tax-exempt status as President Trump has threatened, it would be extremely rare but not unprecedented. Moreover, the only instance in higher education that experts are aware of shows how far a university had to go to lose that coveted status. In 1976, the Internal Revenue Service stripped the tax exemption from Bob Jones University, a private fundamentalist Christian institution in Greenville, S.C., because the school forbade interracial dating by its students. The university objected, saying it wasn't practicing racial discrimination because the policy applied to all students. The case went all the way to the Supreme Court, which upheld the IRS action in 1983. The 8-1 ruling likely would be the legal precedent for the Trump administration if it revokes Harvard's tax-exempt status over allegations it practiced discrimination through diversity, equity, and inclusion initiatives and a failure to protect Jewish students from antisemitic harassment by Gaza war protesters. "In 1983, the Supreme Court established the precedent that universities which practice racial discrimination can be stripped of their nonprofit status," conservative activist Christopher Rufo

BOB JONES, Page A8

## International students push against threats

'More than ever, we need to have each other's backs'

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, Spencer Buell, and Nick Stoico  
GLOBE STAFF

It is the Trump administration's latest threat against Harvard: If the university doesn't turn over disciplinary records of foreign students, the federal government could take away its right to admit students from abroad. Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem issued the warning Wednesday. Accusing Harvard of "bending the knee to antisemitism" and tolerating "anti-American, pro-Hamas ideology," she said that problematic foreign students and faculty must be rooted out. Harvard is perhaps the world's best-known university, the consummate global institution of higher education in the US. Foreign students make up more than one-quarter of its student body. So, without students from all over the world, would Harvard still be Harvard? And what would happen to the thousands of international students who have jobs, degrees, and futures on

STUDENTS, Page A9

## Outside groups claim their lists guide ICE acts

But inaccuracies found in reports about students

By Stephanie Ebbert and Deirdre Fernandes  
GLOBE STAFF

After a shooting at a pro-Israel rally in suburban Newton in September, a Zionist group rushed to fan the flames and called for a boycott of the city. Two months later, Betar US took aim at Memphis, demanding that the murder of an Israeli-born locksmith be investigated as a hate crime. Now, the US chapter of the century-old Zionist group is engaged in its most audacious gambit — attempting to steer government deportations of foreign students who have advocated on behalf of Palestinians. Betar is among a handful of groups that are circulating lists and taking credit for the Trump administration's efforts to deport the people on them. Seven people targeted in recent weeks were flagged on a list compiled by Betar, including two from New England — Tufts University student Rümeysa Öztürk, who was seized in late March,

BETAR, Page A9

## Weight-loss drugs to lose coverage

Blue Cross says it will stop paying for GLP-1 medicines not for diabetes

By Robert Weisman and Scooty Nickerson  
GLOBE STAFF

The state's largest commercial health insurer will stop covering a popular class of prescription drugs for weight loss, effective Jan. 1, cit-

ing soaring costs that are overwhelming insurers and employers. Under its new policy, Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts said Thursday it will continue to cover the meds, known as GLP-1s, in its standard health benefits when

they're prescribed for diabetes — but not for obesity. The insurer will give its largest segment of customers, employers with 100 workers or more, the option of retaining coverage of the drugs for weight loss by paying an extra charge in their health plans. Depending on how the plans are structured, this could also boost premiums for employees.

Blue Cross's move is among the latest signs the surge in demand for GLP-1s, which doctors say provide broad health benefits to their patients, is pushing insurers and employers toward a financial breaking point. "We've been hearing from employers, with increased alarm, about the cost of these medicines,"

WEIGHT LOSS, Page A12



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Sarah McDonough, Lexington History Museums program manager, closed the shutters inside the Hancock-Clarke House.

## PAUL REVERE RODE HERE

★★★★★★★★★★★★

Nearly everyone knows of the famous midnight ride, but retracing the trip that helped start the Revolution reveals few signposts along the way

By Brian MacQuarrie  
GLOBE STAFF

Clandestine signals, a courageous rider, shouts in the dark, and suddenly roused patriots rallying to defend their homes and liberties. The most famous midnight gallop in American history is as indelible a piece of national lore as they come, celebrated in verse and myth. For such a fabled journey, you might think Paul Revere's route would be lined with reminders of his epic dash. But parts of three days spent walking the 17-mile route from Charlestown to Lincoln revealed little love for the rebel messenger. Sure, there's the Paul Revere Restaurant in Medford, a location the famed patriot passed 163 years before the breakfast-and-lunch spot opened in 1938. And there are roads named for him in Arlington and Lexington



Java White of Medford chatted with the staff as he ate breakfast inside Paul Revere Restaurant.



A detail from a painting by Robert Reid of Paul Revere's ride from the Hulton Archive of Getty Images.

that give a nod to the history that sped through there. But if you're looking for much more signage to show the way, whether written in black and white or chiseled in stone, you're out of luck. The Revere connection, pretty much, cannot be found anywhere else along the route. The route begins on busy Warren and Main streets in Charlestown, where Revere set out under a waning gibbous moon; curves around congested Sullivan Square to Broadway in Somerville; veers off Winter Hill to Main and High streets in Medford; and joins Massachusetts Avenue in Arlington before heading to Lexington, crossing Interstate 95, and ending on Battle Road in Lincoln. It's dotted with bodegas and nail salons, cushy homes and three-deckers, and its noisy

REVERE'S RIDE, Page A7

## CONVICTION OVERTURNED



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Edward Wright's wife, Mimi Olivier, embraced Hubert Smith, who was once incarcerated with her husband. Wright served more than 40 years after being convicted of murder. Last week, a judge threw out his conviction and ordered a new trial. B1.

The 20-year-old son of a sheriff's deputy opened fire at Florida State University with his mother's former service weapon, killing two people and wounding at least six others, investigators said. A2.

Aid groups are raising new alarms over Israel's blockade of the Gaza Strip, where it has barred entry of all food and other goods for more than six weeks. A4.

A federal immigration judge denied bond to Rümeysa Öztürk, the Tufts graduate student taken into custody by immigration enforcement agents last month. B1.

President Trump lashed out at Jerome Powell, saying the Fed chair's "termination cannot come fast enough!" B7.

Google acted illegally to maintain a monopoly in some online advertising tech, a judge ruled. B7.

### Spring it on

**Friday:** Sunny, breezy. High: 62-67. Low: 51-56.  
**Saturday:** Lots of pollen. High: 75-80. Low: 50-55.  
Sunrise: 5:58 Sunset: 7:29  
Comics and Weather, **G6-7**.  
Obituaries, **C11**.

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